PARTS OF SPEECH – PART I

Noun | Pronoun | Adjective | Verb | Adverb

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1. NOUN

Definition

A **noun** is a word that functions as the *name of a person, place, animal, thing, idea, quality, or state.*

Grammatically, a noun can function as:

- Subject
- Object
- Complement
- Object of preposition

Examples:

Ram teaches English.
(Ram – Subject noun; English – Object noun)
Ram is a teacher in Thanjavur.
(a teacher - Subject Complement; Thanjavur - Object of the Preposition)

I) Types of Nouns - 5 Types

1. Proper Noun

A **proper noun** denotes ***a specific name*** given to a particular person, place, institution, river, country, etc.

Examples:

- Tamil Nadu
- Meenakshi
- The Himalayas
- The Indian Ocean

Characteristics:

- Always ***begins with a capital letter.***
- Refers to ***one specific entity.***

Example: **Chennai** is the capital of **Tamil Nadu.**

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2. Common Noun

A **common noun** refers to ***a general name*** of a person, place, or thing belonging to a class.

Examples:

- teacher
- city
- mountain
- river

Example:

The **teacher** entered the **classroom.**

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3. Collective Noun

A **collective noun** refers to ***a group of persons or things*** considered as a ***single unit***.

Examples:

- a team of players
- a herd of cattle
- a flock of birds
- a committee of members

Example:

The **team** has won the match. *(The team is treated as a singular unit.)*

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4. Abstract Noun

An **abstract noun** denotes:

- Quality
- Idea
- Feeling
- State
- Concept

It ***cannot be perceived by the five senses.*** (**cannot be seen, touched, heard, smelled, or tasted**). It exists in the **mind**, not in physical form.

Examples:

- honesty
- courage
- freedom
- wisdom
- childhood

Concrete Noun vs Abstract Noun

Concrete Noun has physical existence.

Example:

- Table, river, student, flower

Abstract nouns have no physical form.

Example:

- Beauty, freedom, childhood, wisdom

Sentence comparison:

She has a **book**. (Concrete – book can be touched)

She has **patience**. (Abstract – patience cannot be touched)

What Exactly Does an Abstract Noun Represent?

Abstract nouns represent:

1. Quality: honesty, bravery, kindness, intelligence

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Example:
Honesty is the best policy.

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2. Feeling or Emotion: love, anger, fear, happiness
Example:
Love is powerful.

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3. State or Condition: childhood, poverty, freedom, sleep
Example:
Childhood is a beautiful phase.

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4. Idea or Concept: democracy, justice, truth, education
Example:
Education is important for development.

How Abstract Nouns Are Formed (Important for TNTET)
Abstract nouns are often formed from:
i. From Adjectives

Adjective	Abstract Noun
honest	honesty
kind	kindness
brave	bravery
wise	wisdom

Example:
He is honest.
His honesty impressed everyone.

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ii. From Verbs

Verb	Abstract Noun
move	movement
decide	decision
grow	growth
act	action

Example:
They decided quickly.
Their decision was correct.

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iii. From Common Nouns

Common Noun	Abstract Noun
child	childhood
king	kingship
friend	friendship

Example:
He is my friend.
Their friendship is strong.

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5. Material Noun

A **material noun** denotes ***substances or materials*** from which ***things are made.***

Examples:

- gold
- cotton
- milk
- water

Example:

This ring is made of **gold**. (*Material nouns are generally uncountable.)*

II. Countable and Uncountable Nouns

1. Countable Nouns

Can be counted and **have plural** forms.

Examples:

- pen → pens
- apple → apples

2. Uncountable Nouns

Cannot be counted individually and **do not** usually take **plural forms**.

Examples:

- information
- advice
- furniture
- luggage
- news

Correct usage:

a piece of advice
a piece of information

Incorrect:

❌ advices
❌ furnitures

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III. Number

Regular Plural Formation

book → books

box → boxes

Words Ending in "y"

city → cities

baby → babies

Irregular Forms

man → men

child → children

tooth → teeth

foot → feet

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2. PRONOUN

Definition

A **pronoun** is a word ***used in place of a noun to avoid repetition*** and ***ensure coherence.***

Example:

Ram is a teacher. **He** teaches English.

I. Personal Pronouns

Personal pronouns refer to specific persons or things.

They change according to:

- Person (1st, 2nd, 3rd)
- Number (singular/plural)
- Case (subject/object)

Subject	Object
I	me
we	us
you	you
he	him
she	her
it	it
they	them

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Subject Pronouns

Used as the ***subject of a sentence.***

I, we, you, he, she, it, they

Example:

They are playing.

Object Pronouns

Used as ***an object of verb or preposition.***

me, us, you, him, her, it, them

Example:

She gave **me** a pen.

II. Possessive Forms

Possessive Adjectives

Modify a noun and use it **before a noun.**

my, your, his, her, our, their

my book, your pen, his bag, her dress, our school, their house

Example:

This is my book.

Possessive Pronouns

Replace a noun. It is used **without a noun**.

mine, yours, his, hers, ours, theirs

Example:

This book is mine.

Key Difference (Important)

This is my book. *(Adjective - Comes before noun)*

This book is mine. *(Pronoun - stands alone)*

III. Reflexive Pronouns

Used when **subject and object refer to the same person**.

myself, yourself, himself, herself, itself, ourselves, yourselves, themselves

Example:

She hurt herself. (subject = object)

Used for emphasis:

I completed the work myself.

IV. Relative Pronouns

Introduce a relative clause and **connect a clause to a noun**.

(A clause is a group of words that contains a subject and a verb. If there is no subject + verb combination, it is not a clause. A relative clause is a dependent clause that begins with a relative pronoun)

who – for persons

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whom - persons (object)
which – for things
that – for persons/things
whose – possession

Example:

The boy who came yesterday is absent.
The boy whom we met is absent.
The house which I bought is new.

V. Indefinite Pronouns

Refers to persons or things in **a general way.**

everyone, anyone, someone, nobody, anybody, nothing, something, each, either, neither

Example:

Everyone has completed the task.
(Takes singular verbs.)

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3. ADJECTIVE

Definition

An **adjective** is a word that **modifies or qualifies a noun.**
It provides **additional information** about:

- Quality
- Quantity
- Number
- Demonstration
- Possession

I. Five Types

1. Adjective of Quality

Describes nature or quality.

honest, tall, brave

Example:

He is an **honest** man.

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2. Adjective of Quantity

Indicates amount.

some, much, little

Example:

There is **little** water in the bottle.

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3. Adjective of Number

Indicates number or order.

one, two, first, second

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Example:
She bought **three** books.

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4. Demonstrative Adjective
Points out or **identifies a specific noun.** It comes before a noun. It answers the question: Which one?

Singular - this, that
Plural - these, those

Example:
This pen is mine.
That house is large.
These students are active.
Those mountains are beautiful.

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5. Possessive Adjective
Shows **ownership or possession.** It comes before a noun, and cannot stand alone. It answers the question: Whose?

my, your, his, her, its, our, their

Example:
Their house is large.
This is my book.
That is her bag.
Our school is famous.

II. Degrees of Comparison
Used to compare nouns.
Positive Degree - Tall
Comparative Degree - Taller
Superlative Degree - Tallest
Examples:
Ravi is **tall**.
Ravi is **taller** than Ramesh.
Ravi is the **tallest** boy in the class.
Irregular forms:
good – better – best
bad – worse – worst

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4. VERB

Definition
A **verb** is a word that expresses:

- Action - shows what someone or something does.
- State - expresses a condition, situation, feeling, possession, or state of existence rather than an action.
- Occurrence - describes events or changes that happen naturally.

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Example:

She **writes**. (action)

She **is** happy. (state)

The tree **fell**. (occurence)

I. Main Verb (Principal Verb)

The **main verb** carries the primary meaning of the sentence.

Examples:

She is singing.

They **play** cricket.

In "She is singing" – "singing" is the main verb.

II. Auxiliary Verb (Helping Verb)

An **auxiliary verb** helps the main verb to form:

- Tense
- Voice
- Emphasis
- Question form
- Negative form

It does not carry the main meaning of the sentence.

Primary auxiliaries:

be (is, am, are, was, were, be, been, being)

have (has, have, had)

do (do, does, did)

Examples:

She is writing.

They have completed the work.

Do you like coffee?

III. Modal Auxiliary Verbs

Express ability, possibility, permission, obligation, advice, etc.

can, could, may, might, must, shall, should, will, would

Examples:

She can swim. (ability)

You must obey the rules. (obligation)

May I come in? (permission)

It might rain. (possibility)

You should study well. (advice)

IV. Transitive Verb

Requires an object to complete meaning. It transfers action from subject to object. Structure: Subject + Verb + Object.

She wrote a letter.

(wrote – verb; letter – object)

He bought a car.

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(car = object)

They solved the problem.

(problem = object)

V. Intransitive Verb

Does not require an object. The action does not transfer to anything.

She slept.

The baby cried.

He arrived.

They laughed.

Important Contrast

She broke the glass. (Transitive)

The glass broke. (Intransitive)

Same verb - different function.

VI. Finite Verb

A verb that changes according to:

- Tense, Number, Person

It forms the main verb of a clause.

Example:

She goes.

They go.

She went home.

VII. Non-Finite Verb

Does not change according to subject.

Forms:

- Infinitive (to go)
- Gerund (going)
- Participle (gone, going)

Example:

Swimming is good exercise.

VIII. Subject–Verb Agreement

Verbs must agree with the subject in number and person.

He goes.

They go.

Each student has completed the work.

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5. ADVERB

Definition

An **adverb** modifies:

- A verb
- An adjective

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- Another adverb

An adverb adds extra information.

I. Adverb Modifying Verb

When an adverb modifies a verb, it tells us: How?When?Where?How often?To what extent? about the action.

She runs fast.

He spoke loudly.

II. Adverb Modifying Adjective

An adverb can also modify an adjective. It tells us the degree or intensity of the quality. Usually answers: “How much?” or “To what extent?”

She is very tall.

(The word “very” modifies “tall”.)

III. Adverb Modifying Another Adverb

She runs very fast.

(“very” modifies “fast”.)

IV. Five Types of Adverbs

1. Manner

slowly, carefully

She wrote carefully.

2. Time

now, today

He will come tomorrow.

3. Place

here, there

Sit here.

4. Frequency

always, often

She always speaks the truth.

5. Degree

very, too, quite

It is too hot.

EXAMINATION FOCUS AREAS (TNTET)

Frequently tested components:

- Abstract nouns
- Irregular plurals
- Relative pronouns
- Possessive adjective vs pronoun

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- Degree transformation
- Auxiliary verbs
- Modal verbs
- Subject–verb agreement
- Adjective vs adverb distinction

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